

Nordwind Logistics AS

Standard Operating Procedure — Quotation Handling

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1. Purpose and scope

This procedure governs the preparation, approval and issue of freight quotations for all Nordwind Logistics business units. It applies to sea, road and air freight, to groupage and full-load consignments, and to both spot enquiries and contracted tender pricing.

All quotations are prepared by the quotation desk, which comprises 12 staff across 3 branches: Bergen (6), Oslo (3) and Rotterdam (3). No quotation may be issued to a customer by any other function.

2. Receipt of enquiry

2.1 All customer enquiries are received into the shared mailbox quotes@nordwind.no. Enquiries received by telephone are entered into the mailbox by the receiving employee before any pricing work begins.

2.2 The Quotation Desk Lead reviews the mailbox each working morning and assigns each enquiry to a named quotation clerk by moving the item to the clerk's designated mailbox folder.

2.3 Enquiries received after 15:00 local time are assigned on the following working day.

3. Preparation of the quotation

3.1 The assigned clerk shall establish whether the customer has previously been quoted for the same or a comparable lane within the preceding six months. Where a prior quotation exists, the clerk shall ensure consistency of pricing basis and shall record any deviation.

3.2 Base freight rates are obtained from the NordQuote rate database. Where the carrier has issued a revised tariff since the last quarterly NordQuote update, the current carrier rate sheet held on SharePoint takes precedence.

3.3 The following components shall be included in every quotation where applicable: base freight, origin haulage, destination haulage, customs clearance, documentation fee, and any surcharges in force at the date of issue (bunker adjustment factor, congestion, currency adjustment).

3.4 The quotation shall be prepared using the approved Excel quotation template (QMS-04-T1). Manual calculation outside the template is not permitted.

3.5 Validity. Unless otherwise agreed, quotations are valid for 14 days from the date of issue. Quotations involving out-of-gauge or project cargo are valid for 7 days.

4. Approval

4.1 No quotation shall be issued to a customer without the prior written approval of the Commercial Director.

4.2 Approval is requested by forwarding the completed quotation template to the Commercial Director by email. The Commercial Director shall record approval by reply.

4.3 In the absence of the Commercial Director, approval authority passes to the Managing Director. This provision is to be used only where the delay would otherwise exceed one working day.

4.4 This control was introduced in November 2019 following a review of underpriced business in that financial year and shall not be varied without Board approval.

5. Issue and record

5.1 The approved quotation is issued to the customer by email from the assigned clerk, copying the responsible salesperson.

5.2 A copy of the issued quotation is retained in the clerk's sent items. No central register of issued quotations is maintained.

5.3 Where a quotation is accepted by the customer, the assigned clerk shall create the corresponding booking in Winfreight. All commercial terms shall be entered to match the issued quotation exactly.

6. Reconciliation

6.1 The Quotation Desk Lead shall, each Friday, compare all quotations accepted during the week against the corresponding Winfreight bookings and shall record any discrepancy on form QMS-04-F2.

6.2 Where a discrepancy is identified between the price quoted to the customer and the price recorded in Winfreight, the price quoted to the customer shall stand. The Winfreight record shall be corrected.

7. Exceptions

7.1 Dangerous goods. Consignments classified under ADR or IMDG require completion of the dangerous goods questionnaire (QMS-11-T3) and pricing by a clerk holding current DGSA-supervised certification.

7.2 Temperature-controlled consignments require confirmation of equipment availability from the carrier before a price is issued.

7.3 Consignments originating or terminating outside the European Economic Area require full customs treatment. The flat clearance fee at 3.3 shall not be applied.

7.4 Out-of-gauge and project cargo shall be priced individually. The quotation template is not used.

7.5 Annual tender submissions are prepared by the Commercial Director with support from the quotation desk and are outside the scope of sections 2 to 5.

8. Records

8.1 Completed reconciliation forms QMS-04-F2 are retained for 24 months.

8.2 This procedure is reviewed annually by the Head of Operations.